

1 / 5 | Ages 7-8 | 20 minutes

## Island symbols and map keys

### What we are practising

Communicate a made-up place using consistent visual symbols.

### What you need

Paper / Pencils

Describe a map aloud while a partner draws.

### Before you begin

Choose an island name and draw its coastline.

Keep the island fictional; do not include a home address or private routes.

### Try it together

1. Add four landmarks, such as a pond, hill, library and garden.
2. Invent one symbol per landmark and repeat the symbols in a map key.
3. Connect two places with a path and describe a journey along it.
4. Ask a partner to locate a place using only the key.

### Talk, draw or show your idea

Which symbols are easy to confuse, and how could you change them?

### Space to explore

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2 / 5 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

## Rhythm conversation

### What we are practising

Create, repeat and deliberately vary a rhythmic pattern.

### What you need

No materials

Use silent hand gestures or spoken syllables instead of claps.

### Before you begin

Agree on two gentle sounds, such as clap and knee tap.

Keep sounds comfortable, stop if anyone dislikes them and avoid striking objects or people.

### Try it together

1. Make a four-beat pattern, for example clap, tap, tap, rest.
2. Have your partner repeat it, keeping the rest silent.
3. Swap roles and change just one beat.
4. Join the two patterns into an eight-beat conversation.

### Talk, draw or show your idea

How does a rest change the pattern without adding a sound?

### Space to explore

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3 / 5 | Ages 7-8 | 20 minutes

## A pattern that tiles

### What we are practising

Use repetition and alignment to build a continuous pattern.

### What you need

Paper / Pencil / Ruler if available

Fold the paper to make a grid instead of using a ruler.

### Before you begin

Draw a grid of equal squares, at least three across and three down.

Draw on scrap paper; do not mark household surfaces.

### Try it together

1. Draw the same simple motif in each square, such as a diagonal line.
2. Keep lines meeting at matching corners or edge midpoints.
3. Add a repeating two-symbol pattern to the squares.
4. Describe the smallest part that repeats.

### Talk, draw or show your idea

Which features must line up for the pattern to continue?

### Space to explore

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4 / 5 | Ages 7-8 | 20 minutes

## Folded characters on stage

### What we are practising

Show character goals through words and actions.

### What you need

Two sheets of paper / Pencils

Use hands as characters or draw them on one sheet.

### Before you begin

Fold each sheet in half into a tent shape and draw a face on it.

Use fictional disagreements and allow a child to observe instead of perform.

### Try it together

1. Give each character a different wish, such as reading quietly or singing.
2. Write or say two lines for each character explaining the wish.
3. Act out a meeting and invent a workable agreement.
4. Perform again with a different ending.

### Talk, draw or show your idea

What agreement lets both characters do something they value?

### Space to explore

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5 / 5 | Ages 7-8 | 30 minutes

## Design a pencil home

### What we are practising

Design for a specific need and revise using a practical test.

### What you need

Clean small box / Scrap paper / Tape / Three pencils

Draw the organizer and test a folded-paper divider in an existing box.

### Before you begin

Choose a low stable box with no sharp staples or edges.

An adult checks reused packaging and handles any cutting; use no hot glue or sharp tools.

### Try it together

1. List two needs, such as finding a pencil quickly and preventing rolling.
2. Sketch a design with folded-paper compartments.
3. Make one version with tape and place the pencils horizontally inside.
4. Test removing and replacing each pencil, then change one feature.

### Talk, draw or show your idea

Which change made the organizer more useful?

### Space to explore

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## For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

### 1. Island symbols and map keys

#### **A little hint**

Give each symbol a distinct shape, not only a different colour.

#### **Answer / what to notice**

Many maps work if symbols are used consistently and the key explains them.

A map simplifies a place so useful information can be found quickly.

#### **Make it easier**

Use three landmarks with picture symbols.

#### **Take it further**

Add a scale such as one grid square equals ten imaginary steps.

#### **Another day, away from the screen**

Create a treasure clue that relies on two map landmarks.

## For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

### 2. Rhythm conversation

#### A little hint

Count four evenly spaced beats, including the quiet one.

#### Answer / what to notice

Any repeatable sequence works; the partner should preserve both sounds and rests.

Rhythm includes the timing of silence as well as sound.

#### Make it easier

Use a two-beat call and response.

#### Take it further

Keep the same rhythm but change which gentle sounds produce it.

#### Another day, away from the screen

Give a familiar poem a gentle repeating beat.

## For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

### 3. A pattern that tiles

#### A little hint

Choose the same starting and ending positions on each square.

#### Answer / what to notice

Many designs work; equal squares cover a region without gaps, and matching edges make the motif continuous.

Repeating one small unit can create a larger organized design.

#### Make it easier

Decorate a row of four squares.

#### Take it further

Rotate alternate motifs and predict the new larger pattern.

#### Another day, away from the screen

Look for repeating units in tiles, fabrics or book covers.

## For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

### 4. Folded characters on stage

#### A little hint

They could choose different spaces or take turns.

#### Answer / what to notice

Possible endings include separate spaces or agreed turns; explain how both characters are heard.

Dialogue becomes clearer when the audience understands what each character wants.

#### Make it easier

An adult voices one character and models a request.

#### Take it further

Add a narrator who summarizes without taking sides.

#### Another day, away from the screen

Make a small theatre programme with the title and characters.

## For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

### 5. Design a pencil home

#### A little hint

A divider that looks good may still be too narrow for a pencil.

#### Answer / what to notice

A successful organizer meets the chosen needs, stays stable and lets pencils be taken out easily.

Testing reveals practical problems that a drawing can miss.

#### Make it easier

Decorate and label an existing compartment.

#### Take it further

Design a removable divider and compare two arrangements.

#### Another day, away from the screen

Use the organizer for a day and note one possible improvement.